

Abdullah Al Zahid

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Talent Acquisition

Strategy, Planning & Partnerships

Metrolinx, 97 Front Street West, Toronto, ON

Re: Senior Advisor, Strategy, Planning & Partnerships

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Advisor, Strategy, Planning & Partnerships position. I worked at Metrolinx for a year as a Transportation Planner in Simulation and Modelling, and I would like to be considered for a role closer to the investment questions that sit behind that work.

The posting describes technical analysis of the trade-offs and benefits of transit investments, and deliverables that senior management can read quickly. At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to test how infrastructure constraints and speed restrictions changed run times and schedule reliability, and I presented that evidence to schedulers, operations staff and engineers. At the City of Toronto I analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to work out where capacity is short and what that means for future investment, and I write the briefing notes that come out of it.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions. I work in Python, SQL, ArcGIS Pro and QGIS, and Excel, and I have built the dashboards and datasets that my division reports from.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not built investment-grade business cases or ridership forecasts, and I have not done formal cost-benefit analysis; my work has been on the operations, network-data and review side. I have not used EMME, TransCAD or VISUM, or R, STATA or SAS. I would be glad to be considered on the strength of the analytical work above and my master's degree in transportation engineering.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

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